

ID: SOMA-M-T05A-P13

Title: Letting Go (Variation A) with Mindful Eating

Timing Audit:

- **Total Duration:** 12m 00s (**899** words; 181 Intro + 11 Bridge + 707 Practice)
- **Intro + Bridge:** 2m 00s (**192** words; 181 words + 11w Bridge)
- **Practice:** 10m 00s (**707** words)
- **Silence:** 140s total (3 Long, 4 Short, 1 Final)

Readability: Grade 5

Script Content:

[Intro]

Welcome to this practice. Today we will explore Letting Go.

We often move through our days carrying a heavy mental load. It is like hiking up a mountain while wearing a heavy backpack. This backpack is filled with rocks. One rock is a worry about the future. Another rock is a regret about the past. Another rock is the pressure to rush and get things done.

We get so used to the weight that we forget we are carrying it. We think the heaviness is just part of who we are. Letting Go is the moment you choose to take the backpack off. You set it down on the side of the trail. You do not have to destroy the backpack; you simply choose not to carry it for a few minutes.

When we let go, we stop carrying the burden of "what comes next." We stop carrying the need to control every outcome. We allow ourselves to walk light. We simply set the heavy backpack down by the side of the trail, allowing ourselves to rest exactly as we are.

[Bridge] Now, we will move into a short practice to explore this.

[Practice]

When you're ready, let's begin this practice.

Today we will explore this practice of eating with awareness. This practice is an opportunity to slow down and notice the experience of eating. We are going to explore what it feels like to eat with attention and care, being present with each bite, each sensation, and each moment.

Eating is something we do every day, often quickly or while doing other things at the same time. There is no right or wrong way to eat for this practice. The idea is to notice the eating experience. You may have a meal, a snack, or a small piece of fruit. Whatever you are having, the eating of the food can become the focus of your attention.

You may notice tastes, textures, colors, smells, and even the sounds of eating. Some parts of the experience may feel pleasant, others neutral, and sometimes parts of it may feel less enjoyable.

Begin by taking a moment to notice where you are right now. Settle into a comfortable posture where you will be eating. Get a sense of the chair or surface supporting the body, and the feet on the ground. You may wish to take a slow, deep breath if that feels alright for you.

Look at the food in front of you. Notice with interest the shapes, the colors, and how the food is arranged on the plate. See if you can do this without judging what you see as “good” or “bad.” Over this practice, we will notice how the body responds, how our attention shifts, and how eating with awareness can feel nourishing.

[Short Pause] (10s - Visual observation)

When you are ready bring your hands or cutlery near the food. If you are using your hands, feel the food’s texture, maybe also temperature and weight. If you are using a fork, spoon or something else, attend to the sensations present as well – perhaps hardness or softness.

[Short Pause] (10s - Tactile contact)

If your attention drifts to thoughts, gently return your focus to the food.

[Short Pause] (10s - Re-centering)

Now, take a bite of the food. There is no need to rush. Feel the textures in your mouth – at the lips, the tongue, the teeth. Chew slowly enough to notice the taste and flavors. Some bites might feel crunchy, others soft. Some may taste sweet, savory, sour, bitter, or spicy.

Let go of any judgment about whether you are eating the “right” way. Allow the experience to unfold naturally. Be aware of how the food smells, how it moves inside your mouth, how the tongue is sensing different flavors and various textures. You may also notice any small sounds that occur as you chew or swallow. These sounds are part of the sensory experience and can help bring more attention to the present moment.

As you eat, you may notice feelings of satisfaction, curiosity, or even distraction. Allow these to be a part of the process, without the need to chase them away.

[Long Pause] (30s - Chewing and tasting)

If you find yourself eating quickly, notice that impulse. You may wish to pause and take a breath. Allow the act of eating to become a gentle rhythm rather than a race. Attend to your body’s signals – noticing hunger, fullness, comfort, discomfort. There is no need to finish everything, and there is no pressure to eat more than what feels enough. There is no goal beyond being present with your experience.

You might notice thoughts arising, perhaps about tasks, plans, or what comes next. You might also notice emotions arising – maybe impatience, joy, or gratitude. Let them be here and return to your food.

[Long Pause] (30s - Rhythmic eating)

With each bite, notice how your body responds. Perhaps the stomach or jaw softens. Perhaps you sense temperatures rising or changing in the body. There is no specific feeling the body is supposed to experience.

[Short Pause] (10s - Bodily response)

If you feel hunger fading, notice that. If certain flavors delight you or certain textures surprise you, notice that too. Kindly let go of expectations about what eating should feel like. Allow this eating exercise to be an exploration of sensations.

[Long Pause] (30s - Satiety and sensation)

As you come to the end of the meal, or when you're ready to end the practice, pause and notice the experience once more. Any lingering flavors or textures in the mouth, any sensations in the body.

[Pause] (20s - Final integration)

Thank you for your practice.

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